

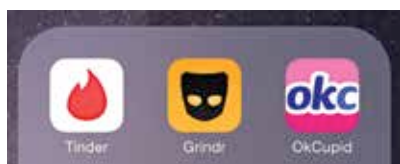
KASPERSKY

Kaspersky moves to Switzerland

To win back consumer trust, the company is moving some of its operations from Russia to Switzerland. <https://digit.in/jun18-B39-1>

**WhatsApp improves groups**

WhatsApp is adding descriptions, rules and topics for groups and granular user permissions. <https://digit.in/jun18-B39-2>



Dating apps have seen an unprecedented growth since their inception, this growth coincides with the rise of STIs and STDs as well.

END OF 'MIXED ATTRACTIVENESS DATING'?

Assortative Mating pattern, or “a form of sexual selection in which individuals with similar genotypes and/or phenotypes mate with each other more often”, is pretty prevalent. Mixed attractiveness dating is the rather offensive term coined up for the scenario where one partner is better looking than the other. Despite the former, randomness prevails in our world and we end up with mixed attractiveness couples, who are incredulously happy. This is because knowing the person for a prolonged period of time before dating manifests a higher possibility of attraction that is based beyond looks alone and delves into the nuances of the individual's personality, according to a study taken up by the online journal Psychological Science. The technosexual dating apps eliminate this wonderful peculiarity and downgrade dating to the brass tacks – the looks and “love at first lust”. This spells doom for mixed attractiveness dating and simplifies a process, which is inherently not supposed to be simple.

RELATIONSHIPS ARE BEING GAMIFIED AND SEXUALISED

As Tomas Chamorro-Premuzic wrote for the Guardian, “In our technosexual



The technosexual dating area eliminates the randomness of dating and makes it transactional and superficial.

era, the process of dating has not only been gamified but also sexualised, by technology”. The chase for the perfect man/woman is endless, because how can you be truly satisfied when there are more options to swipe through and the possibility of finding that perfect puzzle piece to fit you still exists. Eventually, people become addicted to the thrill of seeking out multiple partners. Polygamy and cheating have become incredibly common in our technosexual generation. The apps have also overly sexualised dating, where hookups seem like conquests and you're in a race to have the highest number of sexual partners.

Troy Ertelt, a psychologist, believes that apps like Tinder are a lot like a slot machine, hooking users through positive reinforcement which discourages



Match after match can be attained on Tinder and other apps, transforming dating into a numbers game.

them from ever quitting. The hookup apps start metamorphosing and often becomes more arousing than the actual hookup itself. Ertelt says, “You're continually presented with new simulation, and once you're on a date, it might not be consistently reinforcing”.

FANTASY BECOMES BETTER THAN THE REALITY

According to Smith and Anderson (2016), 81% users on dating platforms have confirmed to having lied about their weight, height and more. The best angle, best clothes, face-beautifying filters and a fake social media persona are common to make sure you display the best and not-so-true-to-life version of you. The real personality and true appearance surface when you meet the person IRL. Which may lead to disap-

pointment on your partner's end and in turn lower your self-esteem. Vicious cycle, isn't it? Berger and Luckmann in 1966 extended a theory that stated, it is not the technology that shapes human actions, but human actions that shape technology. The dating app phenomenon aligns with this study. The technosexual era's dating apps create an impossible fantasy based on societal expectations, that is being perpetually chased, which makes fantasy seem more appealing than reality.

Additionally, the world of online dating has sexual predators lurking in every corner. Catfishes are yet another epidemic plague in this world, who rob us of our emotions, and sometimes even our money.

The future of dating apps, despite these negative implications, looks



Dating apps instill the idea amongst its users of a perfect man/woman being out there somewhere, leading to the incessant chase.

promising with 50 million Tinder users as of 2014. With the tech-giant, Facebook getting into this space, dating sites and apps will most definitely see a massive surge with its gargantuan 2.1 billion population. The technosexual era is just getting started. Attempts must be made to prevent sexual offenders from accessing these dating sites. Another approach that could help the addiction and frenzy created by these apps in users, is setting a time or swipe limit. Technosexuality can be liberating for the individuals facing leisure time restrictions due to the dynamic workings of our world and can even help introverts get out there, but their implications can be catastrophic to the users' sanity and security. The future could be drastically safer or scarier depending on the approach we take. 1